Advancing Breastfeeding Support in Arizona

Jennie Bever, PhD, IBCLC; Kimberly Moore-Salas, IBCLC; *Rizwana Biviji, PhD, M.S.

*Presenting author

Background

- Comprehensive lactation support services is essential for successful breastfeeding and improved maternal and infant health outcomes[1].
- Section 2713 of the Public Health Service Act (Affordable Care Act, 2012) requires private insurance plans to cover breastfeeding support and counseling without cost sharing[2].
- However, Medicaid lacks parallel federal requirements mandating coverage of outpatient lactation support services[3].
- This coverage gap disproportionately affects low-income and other underserved communities.

Policy Gap

- We conducted a comprehensive review of Medicaid State Plan Amendments (SPAs)[4] from January 2012 to December 2024 to assess state-level Medicaid reimbursement policies for outpatient lactation consultants and other professionals.
- Fourteen states currently include explicit provisions for lactation coverage and reimbursement within their Medicaid programs.
- Currently, Arizona lacks formal Medicaid reimbursement mechanisms for outpatient lactation services.

Legislative Change

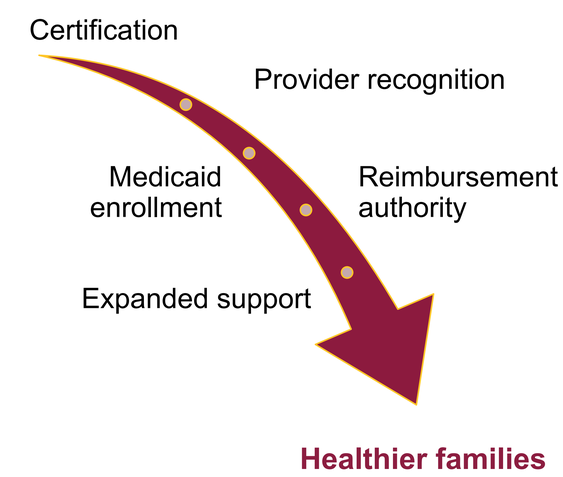
Guided by a systems change framework, we translated research-identified structural gaps into legislative action through two Arizona bills aimed at advancing breastfeeding support.

HB 2051: Adds breastfeeding and lactation services provided in inpatient, outpatient, home-based, and group settings to the list of medically necessary services that AHCCCS contractors must cover.

HB 2072: Establishes a voluntary state certification program for lactation care providers, authorizing the Arizona Department of Health Services (AZDHS) to issue two-year certifications to qualified applicants and to define scope of practice, competency standards, and certification requirements.

Legislative Lifecycle: Bills HB 2051 & HB 2072 (2025-2026)

Policy Impact



REFERENCES

1. Meek, J. Y., & Noble, L. (2022). Policy Statement: Breastfeeding and the Use of Human Milk. *Pediatrics*, 150(1), e2022057988.
2. Health Resources and Services Administration (2025). *Women's preventive services guidelines*. HRSA.gov.
3. Webber, E., & Benedict, J. (2015). Billing for professional lactation services: A collaborative practice approach. *Clinical Lactation, 6*(2), 60–65.
4. Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (n.d.). *Medicaid State Plan Amendments*. Medicaid.gov.

Scan to Access the Lactation Support Policy Brief

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

This project is supported by the Vitalyst Systems Change Grant from the Vitalyst Health Foundation. We also extend our gratitude to the Arizona Maternal Health Policy Coalition (AZMHPC) members and stakeholders for their ongoing support.